

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

Stability First Accord

*A Simplified, Modular Framework for US-Iran Stabilization,
Strait of Hormuz Governance, and Nuclear Resolution*

Version 1.0 | May 2026

Calibrated for the Current Diplomatic Window

Drawing from: Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0

RCSA Simplified Edition 2026 | RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition

Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0 | Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0

Table of Contents

Preamble: The May 2026 Moment

Section 1: Eight Core Principles

Section 2: Framework Overview

2.1 The Three Stages at a Glance

2.2 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

2.3 Modular Design

Section 3: Stage One - The Opening (Days 1-14)

3.1 Day 1: Ceasefire and Stockpile Transfer

3.2 Day 3: Humanitarian Corridor Opens

3.3 Day 7: Synchronized Dual Blockade Lift

3.4 Day 14: Stage One Closing

Section 4: Stage Two - The Exchange (Days 15-60)

4.1 Nuclear Moratorium Architecture

4.2 Fordow Conversion

4.3 Sanctions Relief and Asset Return

Section 5: Stage Three - Permanent Architecture (Days 61-180)

5.1 The International Hormuz Transit Authority

5.2 Regional Security Dialogue

5.3 Full Normalization Path

Section 6: Modular Hormuz Solutions

6.1 Governance Pathways

6.2 Security Pathways

6.3 Economic Pathways

Section 7: Modular Nuclear Solutions

7.1 Stockpile Disposition Options

7.2 Facility Transformation Options

7.3 Verification Choices

Section 8: Five-Channel Verification

Section 9: What Each Side Wins

Section 10: Safeguards and Protections

Section 11: Crisis Management

Section 12: Implementation Roadmap

Appendices

A. Sequencing Matrix Quick Reference

B. Diplomatic Framing Guide

C. Glossary of Terms

Preamble: The May 2026 Moment

As of May 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to a durable agreement since hostilities began on February 28, 2026. Both governments are reviewing a one-page Memorandum of Understanding that would end the war and open a 30-day negotiating window. This document, the **Stability First Accord**, is designed to fill that window with a complete, ready-to-implement architecture.

Why This Moment Is Different

- **US gasoline prices** have reached \$4.53 per gallon nationally (\$6+ in California), creating domestic urgency for resolution.
- **Project Freedom** (the US Navy Hormuz escort operation, launched May 4) was paused on May 6, signaling a shift from military to diplomatic pressure.
- **Iran** has conditionally indicated willingness to transfer its highly enriched uranium stockpile out of the country -- a position it rejected as recently as April 2026.
- **Both sides** have implicitly accepted Pakistan as primary mediator and acknowledge the dual blockade cannot continue.
- **The approaching Hajj pilgrimage** (~May 25) creates a hard deadline where escalation carries severe political costs.
- **A 40-nation European coalition** (led by France's Charles de Gaulle carrier) is forming, providing multilateral legitimacy for joint Hormuz governance.

The current negotiations have converged toward a 12-15 year enrichment moratorium as the compromise between Iran's 5-year offer and the US 20-year demand. On Hormuz, both sides accept reopening but differ on governance. On assets, both accept return but differ on sequencing. These gaps are bridgeable -- but only with a detailed, modular architecture that neither side can claim as capitulation.

What This Document Is

The Stability First Accord is a **simplified, modular diplomatic instrument** drawn from five comprehensive source documents:

Table 1 *Source Document Integration*

SOURCE DOCUMENT	WHAT IT CONTRIBUTES
Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0	Three-stage timeline, synchronized blockade lift, IHTA architecture
RCSA Simplified Edition 2026	Modular track system, sovereignty preservation, economic ladder
RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition	Verification architecture, risk appetite framework, guarantor model
Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0	100 pathways for Hormuz governance, security, and economics
Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0	100 pathways for stockpile disposition and facility conversion

What This Document Is Not

This is not a comprehensive peace treaty. It does not resolve the ballistic missile question, Lebanon final status, Yemen reconstruction, Iraqi militia integration, or the Israeli-Palestinian question. Those matters are reserved for successor frameworks. This Accord creates the stable platform upon which those harder questions can be addressed.

How to Read This Document

Negotiators should read Section 1 (Principles), Section 2 (Overview), and Section 9 (What Each Side Wins) first. Technical specialists should then focus on their domain: Hormuz (Sections 3, 6), Nuclear (Sections 4, 7), Verification (Section 8), or Crisis Management (Section 11). The Appendices provide quick-reference tools for use during active negotiation.

Section 1: Eight Core Principles

Every provision in this Accord is governed by eight foundational principles. These are not aspirational language -- they are the structural rules that ensure the agreement survives implementation.

Principle 1: Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

Neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment is matched by a corresponding US commitment on the same day or the next sequential day. Every US commitment is matched by a corresponding Iranian commitment. Verification is shared. This is not mere political optics -- it is structural. Both governments can credibly claim the other moved first or simultaneously.

Principle 2: Modular Architecture

The Accord operates through independent modules. Failure in one module does not collapse the others. If nuclear verification encounters a dispute, Hormuz transit continues. If sanctions relief faces a delay, the ceasefire holds. This prevents the total-collapse failure mode that destroyed the JCPOA.

Principle 3: Sovereignty Preservation

This framework does not supersede any constitution. It does not create supranational authority. It does not impair sovereign defense rights. It does not force alliance realignment. Iran's NPT rights are preserved. US treaty commitments to Gulf partners are preserved. Both governments retain full constitutional authority.

Principle 4: Irreversible Facts on the Ground

Each stage produces physically irreversible deliverables. Once Iran's weapons-grade stockpile is transferred to IAEA custody in Oman, it cannot be silently returned. Once \$250 million in Iranian assets is transferred, it cannot be clawed back. Once Hormuz is reopened and the IHTA is operating, closure requires a deliberate political decision with visible consequences. These irreversible facts create constituencies for continuation.

Principle 5: Multiple Pathways for Every Major Issue

Rather than demanding a single solution, the Accord provides modular options for Hormuz governance, nuclear disposition, and verification intensity. Parties select the combination that fits their political constraints. The appendices contain selection guides for rapid decision-making.

Principle 6: Quiet Compliance

Minor violations are corrected confidentially through the Joint Implementation Group, not through public accusations. The framework distinguishes between technical discrepancies (corrected quietly) and material breaches (addressed formally). This protects domestic political space for both governments.

Principle 7: Neither Recognition Nor Surrender

Participation in this Accord does not constitute diplomatic recognition where none exists. It does not require either government to acknowledge defeat, capitulation, or unconditional surrender. Each government may characterize the outcome in terms that serve its domestic political requirements, provided objective benchmarks are met.

Principle 8: Succession Resilience

The Accord binds institutions, not individuals. Commitments attach to the Office of the President, the Department of State, the Supreme National Security Council, the Central Bank, and the Majlis. Changes of government activate continuity provisions rather than withdrawal procedures.

Section 2: Framework Overview

2.1 The Three Stages at a Glance

The Accord operates as three sequenced stages, each with defined entry conditions, obligations, verification standards, and transition triggers. The architecture is deliberately modular: failure at any stage does not collapse prior stages.

Table 2 *The Three-Stage Framework*

STAGE	DURATION	PRIMARY GOAL	CLOSING TRIGGER
Stage 1: The Opening	Days 1-14	End the war; transfer stockpile to IAEA custody; reopen Hormuz; lift both blockades	Both blockades lifted; 200+ vessel transits; IAEA custody verified
Stage 2: The Exchange	Days 15-60	Nuclear moratorium; Fordow conversion; sanctions relief; SWIFT reconnection	Nuclear exchange verified; 50% assets returned; SWIFT process begun
Stage 3: Permanent Architecture	Days 61-180	Permanent IHTA treaty; regional security dialogue; successor framework handoff	IHTA charter ratified; 85% assets returned; RCSA/Crescent Compact opened

2.2 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

The sequencing follows what the source frameworks call the **Waltz Philosophy** of synchronized reciprocal motion. The principle is simple: each commitment by one party is matched by a corresponding commitment by the other; neither party is exposed to defection; verification is shared.

Example: Day 1 Synchronization

Iran moves: Transfers entire 60%-enriched uranium stockpile to IAEA custody in Oman; ceases all offensive operations; transmits Hezbollah operational pause instruction.

US moves (same day): Suspends Project Freedom; ceases all offensive operations; issues OFAC license for \$250 million pilot asset release.

Verification: Pakistani PM Office + UN Special Envoy + Omani technical channel + Swiss financial channel issue concurrent certification.

2.3 Modular Design

Six independent tracks advance at their own pace. Progress in one does not depend on progress in another:

Table 3 Six Independent Implementation Tracks

TRACK	INTRODUCED	GOVERNING BODY	INDEPENDENT ADVANCEMENT
Nuclear	Day 1	IAEA + Joint Implementation Group	Yes -- based on IAEA metrics
Maritime Security	Day 1	IHTA Council + Maritime Coordination Cell	Yes -- based on transit data
Economic/Sanctions	Day 7	JIG + Swiss Channel + OFAC	Yes -- based on financial compliance
Humanitarian	Day 1	UN OCHA + IHTA	Yes -- cannot be paused
Regional Security	Day 75	JIG + expanded membership	Requires core party consent
Reconstruction	Day 45	Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund + World Bank	Yes -- based on disbursement metrics

The Rule of Independent Tracks

While tracks advance independently, certain combinations unlock additional benefits:

- Nuclear Track stabilizes + Economic Track activates = SWIFT reconnection pathway opens
- Security Track and Humanitarian Track both advance = Regional Development Fund Stage 2 releases
- Any track may be paused for recalibration without affecting other tracks
- Humanitarian Track operates at full capacity at all times and cannot be paused

Section 3: Stage One -- The Opening (Days 1-14)

Stage One is the heart of the Accord. It runs for 14 days from signature and produces seven irreversible operational deliverables. By Day 14, the dual blockade is lifted, the Joint Hormuz Authority is operating in provisional mode, the war-fighting domain is closed, the first sovereign asset transfer is complete, and Iran's weapons-grade enriched uranium stockpile is under verified IAEA custody in a third country.

3.1 Day 1: Ceasefire and Stockpile Transfer

At 0000 GMT on Day 1, a permanent bilateral ceasefire takes effect on all US-Iran fronts. The following occur simultaneously:

Table 4 *Day 1 Deliverables*

PARTY	ACTION	VERIFICATION
Iran	Transfer entire 60%-enriched uranium stockpile to IAEA custody in Oman; cease all offensive operations; transmit Hezbollah operational pause instruction; transmit Houthi Red Sea pause instruction	IAEA Director-General confirmation; mass spectrometry; continuous CCTV and satellite monitoring
United States	Suspend Project Freedom; cease all offensive operations; issue OFAC general license for \$250M pilot asset transfer; confirm Sovereign Energy Partnership framing in writing	CENTCOM operational order; Pakistani guarantor confirmation; Iranian Central Bank confirms receipt

Why the \$250 Million Pilot Matters

The pilot asset transfer is unconditional and non-reversible. It is not a payment or reparations -- it is the return of Iranian sovereign property. It creates an immediate, visible Iranian win that generates domestic political space for the nuclear steps that follow. The pilot also creates a US interest in completion: once \$250 million has been transferred, the political cost of reversal for the US rises.

3.2 Day 3: Humanitarian Corridor Opens

On Day 3, the first humanitarian-flagged vessel transits the Strait of Hormuz under Joint Hormuz Authority observation. This is a zero-fee, no-inspection-delay transit for food, medicine, medical equipment, and UN supplies. The humanitarian corridor operates at all maturity levels and cannot be paused regardless of disputes in other tracks.

3.3 Day 7: Synchronized Dual Blockade Lift

The single most important mechanical element of Stage One is the synchronized lifting of the dual blockade on Day 7.

Step 1 (Day 1): Both governments issue identical written declarations to the Pakistani guarantor, Omani technical channel, and Swiss financial channel, committing to the synchronized lift on Day 7.

Step 2 (Days 1-6): The Joint Hormuz Authority's Maritime Coordination Cell in Muscat finalizes Day 7 operational protocols. Iran's transit-permit system transitions to JHA-coordinated electronic clearance. US Fifth Fleet establishes coordination links with Iranian Navy through the Omani-hosted hotline.

Step 3 (Day 7, 0000 GMT): Both lifts declared operative simultaneously. JHA observation vessels (US, Iranian, Omani flagged, with international observers) take station at Khasab and Bandar Abbas.

Step 4 (Day 7 +24h): First commercial vessel transits in each direction under JHA observation. Lloyd's List and UN OCHA confirm. JHA issues first daily transit report.

Step 5 (Day 7 +72h): If either lift is not verified by this point, the unlifted side's lift commitment is suspended. Matter referred to JHA emergency session and Pakistani guarantor. Default: maintain both blockades until synchronization is achieved.

3.4 Day 14: Stage One Closing

By Day 14, the following must be verified for Stage One to close:

- Both blockades lifted and verified (JHA observation vessels; Lloyd's List; UN OCHA; guarantor naval observers)

- At least 200 cumulative commercial vessel transits in the 14-day period
- IAEA confirms weapons-grade stockpile in secure custody in Oman
- Ceasefire intact with no verified offensive operations by either side
- JHA provisional mode confirmed with operational Maritime Coordination Cell
- First humanitarian corridor transits confirmed

Upon verification by Pakistan, Oman, and Switzerland concurrently, Stage One closes automatically and Stage Two begins.

US Commitments in Stage One

- Cease all offensive military operations against Iran, Iranian forces, and Iranian-linked installations
- Lift the naval blockade on Iranian commercial ports on Day 7 in synchronized motion
- Suspend Project Freedom unilateral escort operations on Day 1
- Issue OFAC general license for \$250M pilot asset transfer on Day 1
- Issue OFAC general license for humanitarian trade within 14 days (medicine, medical equipment, food, agricultural inputs)
- Pause all new sanctions designations for Stage One duration
- Confirm in writing that the nuclear exchange is a Sovereign Energy Partnership, not an imposed dismantlement

Iranian Commitments in Stage One

- Cease all offensive operations against US forces, US bases, and US-flagged or US-affiliated vessels
- Open the Strait of Hormuz beginning Day 3 (humanitarian) and Day 7 (full commercial), synchronized with US blockade lift
- Withdraw IRGC small craft from positions within 5 nautical miles of the central transit corridor
- Commence good-faith mine-clearing operations with JHA Maritime Safety Working Group
- Initiate stockpile transfer to IAEA custody on Day 1; maintain no enrichment above 3.67% from Day 1 forward
- Transmit to Houthi leadership an instruction to implement a Red Sea operational pause on commercial shipping

Section 4: Stage Two -- The Exchange (Days 15-60)

Stage Two converts the operational stabilization of Stage One into durable economic, institutional, and nuclear measures. By Day 60, half of Iran's frozen sovereign assets have been returned, the first sanctions tranche is operative, the IAEA has fully redeployed, and the comprehensive nuclear exchange is verified complete.

4.1 Nuclear Moratorium Architecture

The current MOU discussions include a moratorium on uranium enrichment of between 12 and 15 years, with Iran's 5-year offer and the US 20-year demand converging toward this range. This Accord adopts a 12-year moratorium with a violation-extension mechanism:

Table 5 Enrichment Moratorium Structure

PHASE	DURATION		ENRICHMENT STANDARD			CONDITION FOR ADVANCEMENT
Moratorium Phase	Years	1-12 (minimum; extendable)	Zero enrichment under IAEA seal.	3.67%. All higher-enrichment centrifuges	above	Clean IAEA certification at 12-year review; no material breach
Civilian Transition	Years	13-15	3.67% enrichment for civilian fuel-cycle purposes at Natanz only	enrichment for civilian fuel-cycle purposes	at Natanz only	Fuel supply guarantee deposited in escrow; Section 123 Agreement operative
Steady-State Civilian	Year	16 onwards	3.67% enrichment under full IAEA safeguards; Phase 3 architecture	enrichment under full IAEA safeguards; Phase 3 architecture	RCSA	five-year renewal confirmed; all compliance indicators at green

Automatic Extension Mechanism

Any material breach of enrichment limits triggers automatic moratorium extension of 2 years per breach. Extension is determined by Joint Implementation Group majority on the basis of IAEA technical reporting, not by unilateral US certification. This prevents the extension mechanism from becoming a tool for geopolitical pressure unrelated to actual nuclear behavior.

4.2 Fordow Conversion

By Day 60, Fordow is converted to a medical-isotope research center producing molybdenum-99, iodine-131, and xenon-133 for regional healthcare under international consortium management. The conversion proceeds through four stages:

- 1. **Phase A (Days 15-30):** Cessation of all enrichment activity; complete inventory; IAEA seals applied
- 2. **Phase B (Days 31-45):** Removal of uranium hexafluoride; down-blending to natural uranium or transfer to Natanz
- 3. **Phase C (Days 46-60):** Removal of enrichment-specific infrastructure; placement in IAEA-monitored storage
- 4. **Phase D (Month 4-18):** IMIRC activation -- international research partnership for medical isotope production under co-management

On Day 60, Iran hosts the inaugural International Medical Isotope Summit, signaling the transition from weapons-grade production to humanitarian medical research.

4.3 Sanctions Relief and Asset Return

Approximately \$100-120 billion in Iranian sovereign assets remains frozen across multiple jurisdictions. The Accord adopts a tranche structure:

Table 6 *Asset Return Tranche Architecture*

TRANCHE	TIMING	AMOUNT	TRIGGER	REVERSIBILITY
---------	--------	--------	---------	---------------

Pilot	Day 1 (Stage 1)	\$250M		Signature		Non-reversible
Tranche 1	Day 30 (Stage 2)	25% minus pilot		Stage 1 closed; IAEA custody verified		Non-reversible
Tranche 2	Day 60 (Stage 2 close)	25%		60-day nuclear compliance; exchange verified		Non-reversible
Tranche 3	Day 120 (Stage 3)	20%		Permanent operational; IHTA Stage 3 dialogue opened		30-day remediation window
Tranche 4	Day 180 (Stage 3 close)	15%		180-day nuclear compliance; exchange maintained		Subject to JIG material-breach review
Reserve	Day 365	10%		12 months sustained compliance		Held pending material-breach determination
Balance	Year 2-3 (RCSA)	Remainder		Full RCSA Phase 2-3 compliance		RCSA risk appetite framework

The pilot and Tranches 1 and 2 are explicitly non-reversible upon transfer. This matches operational reality: Iran's Stage One nuclear and maritime concessions are physically irreversible once executed. The non-reversibility of the first 50 percent of asset return reflects the non-reversibility of Iran's Stage One concessions.

Sanctions Relief Sequencing

Table 7 *Sanctions Relief Sequencing*

TRANCHE	TIMING	SECTORS COVERED
Humanitarian	Day 1	Medicine, medical equipment, food, agricultural inputs, aviation safety parts
Tranche 1	Day 30	Aviation safety parts; consumer exports; specialty goods
Tranche 2	Day 60	Tier 1 banking authorization; OFAC mirror licensing

Tranche 3	Day 120	Petrochemicals; oil services; Tier 2 banking
Tranche 4	Day 180	Oil export normalization; insurance normalization

Section 5: Stage Three -- Permanent Architecture (Days 61-180)

Stage Three converts the provisional arrangements into permanent architecture and opens the broader regional dialogue. It is the bridge to the comprehensive successor framework.

5.1 The International Hormuz Transit Authority

On Day 90, the provisional Joint Hormuz Authority converts to the permanent **International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA)** by treaty. The IHTA Council composition:

Table 8 *IHTA Council Composition*

MEMBER	STATUS	ROLE
Islamic Republic of Iran	Permanent member	voting Senior permanent seat; chair authority in alternating years
United States	Permanent member	voting Permanent seat; co-chair authority in alternating years
GCC Rotating Chair	Permanent member	voting Annual rotation among Oman, Qatar, UAE; tie-breaking authority
European Union	Observer (speaking rights, no vote)	Chairs Environmental and Safety Subcommittee
People's Republic of China	Observer (speaking rights, no vote)	Technical observer; largest Gulf-oil importer
UN Secretary-General Appointee	Neutral chair	Non-voting; tie-breaking on procedural matters

IHTA Decision Rules

- **Routine decisions:** Weighted majority of permanent voting members (any 2 of 3 agree)
- **Enforcement against Iranian-flagged vessels:** Requires Iranian concurrence or neutral chair casting vote
- **Enforcement against all other vessels:** Consensus-minus-one
- **Structural changes:** Unanimous permanent member consent plus 90-day notice
- **Emergency enforcement:** 24-hour mandatory consultation via hotline; narrowly tailored temporary enforcement permitted

Tolling and Revenue

Table 9 *IHTA Tolling Structure*

TIER	VESSEL CATEGORY	RATE
Tier 1	Humanitarian essential (medicine, food, medical equipment)	Zero
Tier 2	Standard commercial (general cargo, container, bulk)	\$0.15/ton
Tier 3	Energy/premium (oil tankers, LNG, chemicals)	\$0.25/ton or \$35,000 flat for VLCC
Tier 4	Vessels of IHTA Council member states	Exempt (pre-notified transit window)

Annual estimated revenue: approximately \$500 million, allocated as: 40% to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (~\$200M/year), 35% to International Maritime Safety Fund, 25% to IHTA Operations and Reserve.

5.2 Regional Security Dialogue

Stage Three does not produce a comprehensive missile agreement. It produces a Regional Security Dialogue framework establishing parameters for confidence-building measures:

- Ballistic-missile range notification protocols

- Regional non-proliferation architecture
- Proxy operational monitoring mechanisms
- Verification architecture including satellite monitoring and JIG-facilitated incident review

5.3 Full Normalization Path

By Day 180, the successor framework -- RCSA v3.6, Crescent Compact v1.7, or RAMES v9.1 -- is formally opened for negotiation. The Stability First Accord has created the stable platform upon which these comprehensive frameworks can be built.

Day 180 deliverables:

- Permanent IHTA charter ratified and in force
- 85% of frozen assets returned (cumulative)
- Successor framework negotiations opened
- Section 123 Agreement (civilian fuel supply guarantee) negotiation framework established
- Regional Security Dialogue active with agenda agreed

Section 6: Modular Hormuz Solutions

The negotiation over Hormuz governance often becomes stuck on a single question: "Who controls the Strait?" This binary framing -- unilateral US enforcement versus Iranian sovereign control -- produces deadlock. The Modular Hormuz Solutions framework dismantles this binary by providing multiple governance, security, and economic options that can be combined into a tailored solution.

How to Use This Section

Negotiators should follow a three-step selection process:

1. **Constraint Mapping:** Identify non-negotiable constraints (US requires freedom of navigation; Iran requires sovereignty recognition)
2. **Category Filtering:** Focus on categories satisfying both sides' constraints

- 3. Portfolio Assembly:** Select 3-5 compatible solutions providing both sides sufficient sovereignty wins

6.1 Governance Pathways

Select one governance model from the following options:

Pathway G-1: Joint Hormuz Authority (JHA) Provisional Council

Speed: 7 days to operational | Complexity: Low | Sovereignty balance: Equal

Establish the provisional JHA with US and Iran as permanent voting members, a rotating GCC chair (Oman/Qatar/UAE), and EU/China/India as observers. The Council meets in Muscat with all decisions requiring weighted majority plus neutral chair concurrence. This is the baseline governance model from which all other solutions derive.

US framing: "US co-governance replaces unilateral enforcement burden with shared responsibility."

Iranian framing: "Iran recognized as permanent co-equal sovereign authority over Hormuz -- ending decades of US unilateralism."

Pathway G-2: Tripartite Council with GCC Rotating Tie-Breaker

Speed: 7 days | Complexity: Low | Sovereignty balance: Slight regional tilt

Simplified three-member governing body: United States, Iran, and a single rotating GCC representative. The GCC member holds tie-breaking authority when US and Iran disagree. This lean structure reduces bureaucratic overhead while ensuring neither superpower dominates.

US framing: "Streamlined decision-making with regional Arab stakeholder as neutral arbiter."

Iranian framing: "No permanent US majority; Muslim Gulf state ensures fair arbitration."

Pathway G-3: Dual-Track Governance (Political + Technical)

Speed: 14 days | Complexity: Medium | Best for: insulating operations from politics

Separate political decision-making (Council ambassadors meeting monthly) from technical operations (permanent Technical Committee of naval officers managing daily transit). Political disputes do not disrupt technical operations; technical recommendations inform but do not bind political decisions.

US framing: "Technical operations insulated from political disputes."

Iranian framing: "Operational decisions made by professionals, not politicians."

Pathway G-4: IMO-Mandated Observer Mission

Speed: 30 days | Complexity: Low | Best for: lighter institutional footprint

Rather than creating a new standalone authority, deploy a UN International Maritime Organization observer mission to Iranian and Omani naval bases. IMO observers monitor transit operations, document incidents, and report to the UN Secretary-General without operational command authority.

US framing: "UN-authorized oversight provides international legitimacy without new bureaucracy."

Iranian framing: "IMO presence is observational, not operational -- no supranational command over Iranian forces."

6.2 Security Pathways

Select one or more security mechanisms:

Pathway S-1: Synchronized Day-7 Dual Blockade Lift Protocol

Required: Yes | Complexity: Medium

Both governments issue identical written declarations committing to synchronized lift on Day 7. JHA Maritime Coordination Cell finalizes protocols (Days 1-6). At 0000 GMT Day 7, both lifts declared operative simultaneously. If either lift not verified within +72 hours, matter referred to JHA emergency session.

Pathway S-2: Omani-Hosted 24/7 De-Confliction Hotline Network

Required: Yes | Speed: 7 days to operational

Three-tier hotline system hosted in Muscat: Tier 1 (operational, naval officers), Tier 2 (diplomatic, senior military liaisons), Tier 3 (heads of government via Omani Foreign Ministry). Operates in Arabic, English, and Farsi with certified military interpreters.

Pathway S-3: Unmanned Picket Line (Autonomous Sensor Network)

Speed: 30 days | Reduces: Manned vessel proximity tension

Deploy autonomous surface vessels and aerial vehicles as early warning sensor net along Hormuz approaches, reducing the need for manned US/Iranian warships to sail in close, tense proximity. USVs carry radar, AIS receivers, and cameras relaying real-time data to the Maritime Coordination Cell.

US framing: "Reduced exposure of US sailors to Iranian proximity."

Iranian framing: "US manned vessels withdrawn from tense close-quarters; Iranian waters respected by autonomous patrol boundaries."

Pathway S-4: Naval Encounter Code of Conduct (INCSEA-Adapted)

Speed: 30 days | Best for: preventing accidental escalation

Adopt an Incidents at Sea agreement adapted for Hormuz, governing all encounters between US Navy, Iranian Navy, IRGC-Navy, and other naval forces. Establishes safe distances, communication protocols, maneuvering rules, and post-incident reporting.

Pathway S-5: IRGC-Navy Force Posture Adjustment Protocol

Speed: Immediate | Reciprocal: Yes

Iranian commitment to withdraw IRGC small craft from positions within 5 nautical miles of the central transit corridor and cease vessel boardings except in JHA-coordinated scenarios. In exchange, US forces maintain minimum safe distance from Iranian territorial waters.

Pathway S-6: Regional Coast Guard Partnership

Speed: 90 days | Best for: transforming military to law-enforcement framing

Transform naval confrontation dynamics by establishing a joint coast guard framework focused on maritime law enforcement (smuggling, piracy, search and rescue) rather than military confrontation. Coast guard vessels replace navy warships for day-to-day Hormuz patrol.

6.3 Economic Pathways

Pathway E-1: \$20 Billion US DFC-Chubb Reinsurance Backstop

Speed: 15 days | Impact: Immediate premium reduction

Activate structured reinsurance partnering the US International Development Finance Corporation with Chubb Ltd. to underwrite war-risk insurance for oil and LNG tankers. Covers reinsurance capacity that commercial markets have withdrawn, lowering war-risk premiums from 3-8% toward pre-crisis 0.25% levels.

Pathway E-2: Tiered Commercial Transit Toll System

Speed: 30 days | Revenue: ~\$500M annually

Graduated toll structure: Tier 1 (humanitarian, zero toll), Tier 2 (standard commercial, \$0.15/ton), Tier 3 (energy/oil/LNG, \$0.25/ton), Tier 4 (military/government vessels, \$0.50/ton). Revenue flows to IHTA operating budget with 40% allocated to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund.

Pathway E-3: Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund

Governance: World Bank trustee with Iranian co-governance

Allocate 40% of IHTA commercial toll revenue to an internationally supervised Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund. Funds directed to healthcare, education, infrastructure, and earthquake recovery -- not military or security sectors. Transparent quarterly disbursement.

US framing: "Revenue channeled to civilian reconstruction, not IRGC."

Iranian framing: "Direct revenue stream from Hormuz co-governance funds national reconstruction."

Pathway E-4: Humanitarian Zero-Toll Fast Track

Speed: Day 1 | Protection: Insulated from all snapbacks

Pre-cleared, fee-exempt transit lane for food, medicine, UN supplies, medical evacuation vessels, and Hajj pilgrimage vessels, entirely insulated from any snapback sanctions. Humanitarian vessels receive priority routing, dedicated coordination, and guaranteed non-interference from any party regardless of broader political conditions.

Recommended Default Portfolio

For negotiators seeking a balanced, rapidly implementable package, the following combination is recommended:

Table 10 *Recommended Default Hormuz Portfolio*

CATEGORY	SELECTION	RATIONALE
Governance	Pathway G-1 (JHA Provisional) transitioning to G-2 (Tripartite Permanent)	Fast start with lean permanent structure
Security	S-1 (Synchronized Lift) + S-2 (Hotline) + S-3 (Unmanned Picket) + S-5 (Force Posture)	Core safety plus de-escalation technology
Economic	E-1 (Insurance Backstop) + E-2 (Tiered Tolls) + E-3 (Reconstruction Fund) + E-4 (Humanitarian Fast Track)	Immediate stabilization plus long-term revenue

Section 7: Modular Nuclear Solutions

The nuclear architecture is the framework's most sensitive component. Rather than dictating a single outcome, this section presents multiple options for stockpile disposition, facility transformation, and verification intensity. Parties select the combination that fits current political realities.

Current Negotiation Parameters (May 2026)

Table 11 Nuclear Negotiation Landing Zones

ISSUE	US POSITION	IRAN POSITION	LIKELY LANDING ZONE
Enrichment moratorium	20 years	5 years	12-15 years (actively negotiated)
HEU disposition	Transfer to US	Remain in Iran	Third-country IAEA custody (Oman)
Underground facilities	Prohibited operation	NPT rights asserted	IAEA-monitored conversion
Fordow	Dismantlement	Preserve facility	Convert to medical-isotope research center
Snap inspections	Required	Rejected	Enhanced declared-site + IAEA unannounced

7.1 Stockpile Disposition Options

The disposition of Iran's transferred weapons-grade material follows IAEA procedures with Iranian consent. Three options are available:

Option N-1: IAEA Third-Country Custody (Oman Model) -- RECOMMENDED DEFAULT

Speed: 14 days | IAEA control: Full | Iranian consent: Required for any disposition

Material remains in IAEA-controlled storage at the Oman custody facility. The facility is under IAEA control -- not US control. Disposition follows IAEA procedures with Iranian consent for any final disposition decision.

US framing: "Weapons-grade material removed from Iranian territory under international control."

Iranian framing: "Sovereign asset held in trust under IAEA supervision, not surrendered to any single power. Iran chose Oman as the neutral custody location."

Option N-2: Fuel Assembly Conversion

Speed: 90 days | Economic value: Maximized for Iran

Weapons-grade material is diluted and fabricated into fuel assemblies for Iran's Bushehr nuclear power plant, with international consortium technical support. Maximizes Iranian economic value from the exchange; eliminates the material permanently; demonstrates civilian energy purpose.

US framing: "Permanent elimination of weapons-grade material through verifiable civilian fuel fabrication."

Iranian framing: "Iran converted weapons-grade material into civilian energy assets -
- maximizing the economic value of the sovereign choice."

Option N-3: Russian Federation Custodial Partnership

Speed: 60-90 days | Leverages: Existing Russia-Iran nuclear cooperation

Transfer HEU stockpile to Rosatom-operated storage at Novouralsk or Seversk under IAEA safeguards. Uses existing Russia-Iran nuclear cooperation framework. Iran may characterize as material held by a trusted nuclear partner under NPT safeguards.

Option N-4: Kazakhstan LEU Bank Custody

Speed: 75-105 days | Precedent: IAEA-established fuel bank

Transfer HEU to IAEA LEU Bank in Oskemen, Kazakhstan, under existing IAEA fuel bank governance structure. Iranian repurchase rights for civilian use are preserved.

7.2 Facility Transformation Options

Option F-1: Fordow International Medical Isotope Research Center (IMIRC) – RECOMMENDED DEFAULT

Timeline: 18-36 months | Output: Mo-99, I-131, Xe-133 for regional healthcare

Permanent conversion of Fordow Fuel Enrichment Plant to medical isotope production facility under international consortium management. Iranian scientists lead world-class medical research center. Most proliferation-sensitive facility permanently neutralized while preserving scientific workforce.

Option F-2: Natanz Open-Fuel-Cycle Research Campus

Timeline: 24-36 months | Focus: Advanced reactor fuel cycles, nuclear safety

Transform Natanz from enrichment center to internationally staffed research campus. Former enrichment hub becomes transparency showcase and premier nuclear research institution with international collaboration.

Option F-3: Isfahan Nuclear Technology Exhibition and Training Center

Timeline: 24 months | Focus: Regional safeguards training hub

Convert Isfahan Nuclear Technology Center into IAEA regional training hub for nuclear safeguards inspectors, safety engineers, and non-proliferation specialists from across the Middle East.

Option F-4: Staged Transfer with Reciprocal Sovereignty Milestones

Timeline: 360 days | Feature: Mutual conditionality without front-loading

HEU transferred in quarterly tranches tied to Iranian sovereignty milestone achievements (asset releases, sanctions relief, IHTA governance), creating mutual conditionality. No unilateral concession; every transfer matched by sovereignty gain.

7.3 Verification Choices

Option V-1: Continuous IAEA Monitoring with Real-Time Data -- RECOMMENDED DEFAULT

Coverage: All declared sites + Oman custody facility

Continuous monitoring at Natanz, Isfahan, and Oman custody facility with real-time data transmission to IAEA headquarters. Weekly environmental sampling. IAEA Director General reports to JIG and UN Security Council.

Option V-2: Joint Implementation Group Technical Discrepancy Panel

Function: Resolve inconsistent findings between verification channels

Where verification channels report inconsistent findings, the JIG convenes a Technical Discrepancy Panel within 72 hours. Panel includes representatives of each reporting channel and a neutral technical expert. Panel findings are advisory; JIG retains final authority. During discrepancy review, no party may take unilateral action.

Option V-3: Public Wins Ledger

Transparency: Continuous | Languages: English, Farsi, Arabic, French

The JIG secretariat publishes a continuously updated Public Wins Ledger documenting, per party: verified benefits delivered; verified obligations fulfilled; cumulative compliance score. The Ledger is symmetric -- every party's wins are documented. This turns compliance into ongoing domestic political capital rather than a technical compliance burden.

Recommended Default Nuclear Portfolio

Table 12 *Recommended Default Nuclear Portfolio*

CATEGORY	SELECTION	RATIONALE
----------	-----------	-----------

Stockpile	N-1 (Oman IAEA Custody)	Fastest; neutral; neither US nor Iran controls
Facilities	F-1 (Fordow IMIRC) + F-2 (Natanz Campus) + F-3 (Isfahan Training)	Complete transformation of all three facilities
Verification	V-1 (Continuous Monitoring) + V-2 (Discrepancy Panel) + V-3 (Wins Ledger)	Robust verification with dispute resolution and transparency

Section 8: Five-Channel Verification Architecture

Verification is the spine of the Accord. The architecture follows the principle that no single verification channel can either trigger or block compliance determinations on its own. Every material finding requires convergent evidence from at least two independent channels.

Table 13 The Five Verification Channels

CHANNEL	ACTIVE	COVERAGE	REPORTING AUTHORITY
Pakistani Mediator	Throughout	Bilateral diplomatic channel; ceasefire compliance; major commitment certification; crisis hotline	Pakistani Prime Minister's Office and designated envoy
Omani Technical	Throughout	Maritime operations; JHA observation; hotline; mine clearance; nuclear custody facility oversight	Omani Foreign Ministry and JHA Secretariat Director
Swiss Financial	Throughout	Asset transfer verification; sanctions relief implementation; escrow management; banking reconnection	Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs
IAEA	From Day 20	Nuclear exchange verification: stockpile custody, enrichment moratorium, Fordow conversion; environmental sampling; weekly technical reports	IAEA Director General; reports to JIG and UN Security Council

National Technical Means	Throughout	Satellite imagery, signals intelligence, all national capabilities. Used as backstop and discrepancy detector	US, partner intelligence services; discrepancies referred to JIG Technical Discrepancy Panel
---------------------------------	------------	---	--

Risk Appetite Framework

Not all violations are equal. The five-tier risk appetite spectrum prevents technical violations from triggering disproportionate political responses:

Table 14 *Risk Appetite Framework*

TIER	LEVEL	EXAMPLE TRIGGERS	RESPONSE
1	Zero Tolerance	Nuclear weapons-related activity; diversion of fissile material; attack on IAEA inspectors	Immediate snapback; highest escalation
2	Minimal Tolerance	Enrichment above agreed limits by >20%; obstruction of IAEA access >72 hours	Snapback presumed but rebuttable; 30-day Panel review
3	Managed Tolerance	Technical reporting delays; minor centrifuge discrepancies; disbursement timing issues	Graduated response: technical assistance, extended timeline, guarantor mediation
4	Strategic Flexibility	Political disagreements; domestic legislative delays; ceremonial protocol disputes	Snapback prohibited; diplomatic and guarantor-led resolution required
5	Absorbed Risk	Force majeure; natural disasters affecting compliance; neutral guarantor incapacity	No penalties; automatic Trigger Dampening Window activated

Joint Implementation Group

The JIG is the central coordination body for Stages 2 and 3, hosted in Geneva. Membership: United States, Iran, Pakistan, Oman, Switzerland, EU observer, UN Special Envoy. PRC and GCC rotating chair join as observers in Stage 3.

The JIG meets in plenary every 30 days, with technical working groups in continuous session. Material-breach determinations require majority of permanent members (US, Iran,

Pakistan, Oman, Switzerland), with Pakistan as facilitating chair.

Section 9: What Each Side Wins

This section provides the diplomatic framing that enables each government to defend the Accord to its domestic audience. Every claim below is factually supportable from the text of the Accord.

What the United States Wins

Table 15 *US Deliverables and Timeline*

WIN	SPECIFIC DELIVERABLE	DAY VERIFIED
Strait of Hormuz reopened	200+ commercial vessel transits per 14-day period; gas-pump prices begin falling within weeks	Day 14
Project Freedom succeeded	Escort assets transition to JHA convoy support; President can credibly claim operation achieved its objective	Day 7
Freedom of navigation in international law	IHTA Charter formally guarantees transit under international treaty; Iran cannot unilaterally close	Day 90 (permanent)
Weapons-grade stockpile eliminated	Entire 60%-enriched stockpile in IAEA third-country custody, verified by mass spectrometry	Day 1 initiated; Day 14 verified
12-year enrichment moratorium secured	Moratorium on enrichment above 3.67% with IAEA continuous monitoring; violation automatically extends	Day 30 (formal entry)
Fordow converted	Fortified Fordow facility producing medical isotopes, not enriching uranium	Day 60
No basing concessions	All US Gulf bases remain; all treaty obligations to GCC partners preserved; no troop withdrawals	Day 1 (confirmed in text)

Congressional oversight preserved	Each asset tranche from Tranche 3 forward subject to 30-day Congressional review window	Throughout	
Israeli security backstop	Weapons-grade stockpile eliminated; moratorium in force; Lebanon track separated	Day 1 onward	

Recommended US Domestic Messaging

"We secured the opening of Hormuz, the elimination of Iran's weapons-grade uranium, a 12-year moratorium on enrichment, and the conversion of Fordow to peaceful use. We got Iranian assets returned in tranches with Congressional review at every step. We didn't give up a single base. American forces remain in the region. And we did it without losing another American life."

What Iran Wins

Table 16 Iranian Deliverables and Timeline

WIN	SPECIFIC DELIVERABLE	DAY VERIFIED
War ends permanently	Permanent bilateral ceasefire; UN-registered; war-fighting domain closed within 14 days	Day 1 (ceasefire); Day 14 (closing)
US naval blockade lifted	Synchronized with Hormuz reopening on Day 7; Iranian commercial ports restored	Day 7
Permanent IHTA governance seat	Permanent voting seat with chair authority on alternating years; formal Iranian co-equality replacing US unilateralism	Day 90 (permanent IHTA)
\$200M/year reconstruction revenue	40% of IHTA revenues to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund; World Bank trustee oversight; Iranian programmatic control	Day 45 (tolling begins)
Return of sovereign assets	\$250M Day 1; cumulative 50% by Day 60 (non-reversible); cumulative 85% by Day 180	Staged through Day 180

Comprehensive sanctions relief	Humanitarian Day 1; aviation/consumer Day 30; SWIFT Day 60; petrochemicals Day 120; full normalization Year 3+	Staged
NPT rights preserved	Enrichment continues at 3.67% after moratorium under guaranteed fuel supply; civilian nuclear rights fully preserved	Throughout
Missile program untouched	Ballistic missile file entirely deferred to Stage 3 Dialogue	Day 1 (confirmed in text)
Constitutional governance preserved	No requirement on Iranian internal governance; Supreme Leader succession unaffected	Day 1 (confirmed in text)

Recommended Iranian Domestic Messaging

"We have ended the war. The American naval blockade of our ports has been lifted. Our frozen sovereign property is returning. The Strait of Hormuz is governed by an international authority on which Iran holds a permanent seat -- replacing decades of American unilateralism. We have chosen to redirect our nuclear program toward guaranteed civilian energy leadership. Our NPT rights remain inviolable; our sovereignty is intact."

What the Region Wins

Table 17 *Regional Benefits*

STAKEHOLDER	KEY BENEFIT
Saudi Arabia & Gulf States	Predictable energy transit; reduced nuclear threat perception; GCC rotating chair on IHTA Council; no new concessions required
Israel	Weapons-grade stockpile eliminated; 12-year moratorium removes reconstitution timeline; Hezbollah operational pause; quiet acquiescence expected

Pakistan	Confirmed primary mediator role; institutionalized guarantor status; strengthened bilateral relationships
Oman	IHTA secretariat in Muscat; Maritime Coordination Cell in Khasab; IAEA custody facility; permanent institutional centrality
France/EU	40-nation coalition finds legitimate institutional home; EU chairs Environmental and Safety Subcommittee
China & India	Predictable energy supply; IHTA technical observer status; documented role in stabilization
Global Energy Markets	20% of global oil and gas returns to predictable transit; Brent crude stabilization

Section 10: Safeguards and Protections

Key Safeguard 1: Failure Without War

Framework failure does not restore war conditions. If the Accord collapses, the bilateral ceasefire remains in force unless explicitly renounced by either party. The 150-day inertia buffer means no instant sanctions snapback -- any party seeking to reverse course must follow a defined, time-consuming procedure.

Key Safeguard 2: Stabilization Holds

When a specific Accord measure becomes domestically untenable in either capital, that measure can be placed on Stabilization Hold for up to 90 days. During the Hold: all other obligations remain in force; after 90 days the measure freezes but the freeze does not constitute a violation. Maximum two Stabilization Holds per stage. Nuclear exchange steps are not eligible for Hold.

Key Safeguard 3: Emergency Ambiguity Authority

The neutral chair possesses Emergency Ambiguity Authority -- the capacity to introduce controlled procedural ambiguity that prevents immediate escalation when clarification would inflame domestic public opinion. May be exercised to delay formal compliance assessments for up to 14 days, issue deliberately ambiguous public statements allowing

multiple domestic interpretations, or create "technical review periods" that function as cooling-off periods.

Key Safeguard 4: Costed Withdrawal

Any party may withdraw through a six-month notification window, orderly asset disposition, infrastructure handover to host states, and personnel repatriation. Nuclear constraints survive withdrawal as residual obligations -- the framework's judgment is that proliferation prevention is a generational responsibility that outlasts any single political agreement.

Key Safeguard 5: Fuel Supply Guarantee Survival

If the US triggers sanctions snapback on non-nuclear grounds, the fuel supply guarantee remains in force unless the JIG determines a nuclear material breach. The US cannot use non-nuclear disputes to cut off Iran's civilian energy supply. This eliminates the vulnerability that drove Iran's enrichment program in the first place.

Key Safeguard 6: Non-Recognition

Participation in this Accord does not equal diplomatic recognition or alliance. The US and Iran remain adversaries in many domains. The Accord creates a functional arrangement for specific, defined purposes without requiring normalization of the broader relationship.

Key Safeguard 7: Succession Resilience

The Accord binds institutions, not individuals. Changes of government -- whether through election, succession, or other means -- activate continuity provisions rather than voiding the framework. The commitments attach to the US Office of the President and Department of State, and to Iran's Supreme National Security Council, Presidency, Central Bank, and Majlis.

Section 11: Crisis Management

The Accord operates in an environment where incidents will occur. The de-escalation architecture is designed to absorb incidents without triggering reflexive escalation.

The 24-Hour Cooling-Off Rule

When an incident occurs, no escalatory action by either party may be taken within the first 24 hours. The window is used for Pakistani guarantor backchannel review, fact-gathering by JHA observation assets, and discrepancy assessment. Both governments have pre-authorized that the first 24 hours after any incident is a fact-finding window, not a response window. Self-defense rights are preserved where an active armed attack is in progress.

Five Independent De-Escalation Pathways

Table 18 *De-Escalation Pathways*

PATHWAY	TRIGGER	DURATION	AUTHORITY
Crisis Lock	10+ fatalities; verified direct military clash; critical infrastructure attack; IAEA integrity alert	14 days; extendable to 42 by JIG majority	JIG majority activation; Pakistan facilitates
Third-Party Spoiler Attribution	Third-party attack or spoiler activity	30-day investigation	JIG-convened attribution panel; neutral technical expert chair
Military Deconfliction Hotline	Any military incident in or near IHTA corridor	Permanent 24/7	Oman-hosted; 2-hour mandatory response
Regional Incident Firewall	Third-party regional escalation threatening framework	Immediate notification within 4 hours	JIG JIG emergency session; Pakistan facilitates
Direct Executive Link	Imminent crisis requiring head-of-state communication	6-hour consultation capability	Pakistan Prime Minister as initial relay

Maritime De-Escalation Protocols

- **Maritime Incident Hotline:** 24/7 Omani-hosted hotline linking IRGC-Navy, US Fifth Fleet, Iranian Navy, and JHA Maritime Coordination Cell. 2-hour mandatory response window.

- **Vessel Harassment Parameters:** Approach within 100 meters at speed; illumination with targeting radar; simulated attack maneuvers. Any harassment triggers immediate hotline and 24-hour JIG notification.
- **No-Seizure Zone:** Commercial vessels in IHTA corridor international waters may not be seized by any party without prior JHA notification.
- **Lane Separation:** Three lanes separated by 5-nautical-mile buffers. Speed limit 15 knots.
- **Carrier Transit Notification:** US carrier-group transits occur only during pre-announced 48-hour windows. Iranian Navy may observe from beyond 20 nm but may not intercept.

Drone Incident Handling

Drone incidents are the most likely source of accidental escalation. The protocol provides:

- **Immediate:** Cross-border drone intrusion triggers automatic JMOC notification and flight-path data sharing
- **Attribution:** Joint technical team deployed within 48 hours to confirm origin and intent
- **Response proportionality:** Pre-authorized response options based on drone class (surveillance, armed, commercial)
- **No retaliation without attribution:** 72-hour minimum investigation period before any punitive response

Section 12: Implementation Roadmap

Pre-Signature Phase (T-5 Days to T-0)

DAY	ACTION	RESPONSIBLE
T-5	Both governments confirm agreement to proceed; designate senior officials for coordination	Heads of Government
T-4	Omani Foreign Ministry confirms Muscat facilities ready; JHA provisional charter drafted	Oman

T-3	Swiss financial channel confirms escrow architecture; IAEA confirms Oman custody facility readiness	Switzerland / IAEA
T-2	Pakistani guarantor confirms mediation team deployment; UN Special Envoy confirms readiness	Pakistan / UN
T-1	Both governments issue internal instructions to military commands for ceasefire compliance	Military Commands
T-0	Signature ceremony (Muscat or Geneva); ceasefire effective 0000 GMT next day	Foreign Ministers

Operational Costs and Funding

Table 19 *Estimated First-Year Costs*

ITEM			ESTIMATED COST	FUNDING SOURCE
JHA/IHTA Secretariat (Muscat)			\$12M	IHTA toll revenues
Maritime (Khasab)	Coordination	Cell	\$4M	IHTA toll revenues
IAEA	Oman custody facility operations		\$8M	IAEA regular budget + voluntary contributions
Mine clearance operations (6-month)			\$25M	International Maritime Safety Fund
Insurance backstop facility			\$20B contingent liability	US DFC + Chubb Ltd. + Lloyd's market
Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (Year 1)			\$200M	40% of IHTA toll revenues
JIG Geneva Secretariat			\$3M	Switzerland + proportional party contributions

Critical Success Factors

- 1. Speed in Stage One:** The first 14 days must produce visible, irreversible deliverables. Delays in Stage One erode political capital for both governments.

- 2. **Israeli Coordination:** The single highest-risk scenario is a coordinated Israeli military strike on Iranian nuclear facilities during Stage Two. The architectural response is to accelerate Stage Two to maximum feasible pace and provide Israeli leadership with sufficiently detailed advance briefings.
- 3. **Domestic Political Protection:** Both governments need immediate, visible wins. The \$250M pilot, Hormuz reopening, and ceasefire must be communicated as achievements on Day 1.
- 4. **Verification Credibility:** The five-channel verification system must be fully operational by Day 7. Any perception that verification is one-sided will collapse Iranian participation.
- 5. **Successor Framework Readiness:** By Day 90, the RCSA v3.6, Crescent Compact v1.7, or RAMES v9.1 negotiation framework must be ready to open. The Stability First Accord is a bridge, not a destination.

Appendices

Appendix A: Complete Sequencing Matrix Quick Reference

Table 20 180-Day Sequencing Matrix

DAY	US MOVES	IRAN MOVES	VERIFICATION
1	Suspend Project Freedom; cease offensive ops; issue \$250M OFAC license; confirm Sovereign Energy Partnership framing	Cease offensive ops; initiate stockpile transfer to IAEA Oman custody; transmit Hezbollah pause; transmit Houthi pause	Pakistan PM + UN Special Envoy + Oman + Switzerland concurrent certification
3	OFAC humanitarian license issued	First humanitarian-flagged vessel cleared for Hormuz transit	Lloyd's List + UN OCHA + JHA observation post
7	Lift naval blockade; transition Project Freedom assets to JHA convoy support	Open Hormuz to commercial transit; withdraw IRGC small craft; commence mine-clearing	JHA observation vessels; Lloyd's List; UN OCHA

14	Stage 1 closing certification	Stage 1 closing certification	Pakistan + Oman + Switzerland concurrent; Stage 2 automatic
15	Welcome IAEA full redeployment under Partnership terms	Issue IAEA invitation for declared sites; continuous monitoring installed	IAEA Director General confirms; satellite corroborates
20	OFAC issues aviation safety and specialty export licenses	Confirm IAEA continuous monitoring operational	JIG verification
30	First sanctions tranche operative; process second asset tranche; 30-day Congressional notification	Declare and verify 3.67% civilian moratorium; idle higher-enrichment centrifuges under IAEA seal	IAEA continuous monitoring; JIG certification; Congressional review
45	Confirm JHA transition to operating mode with Tier 1 and Tier 2 tolling	Confirm IHTA tolling operative; first toll collections	JHA Council unanimous certification
60	Process third asset tranche (cumulative 50%); commence SWIFT reconnection	Fordow conversion verified; host International Medical Isotope Summit; IHTA Tier 3 tolling	JIG closing certification; Stage 3 automatic
75	Open Regional Security Dialogue framework; bilateral teams convene in Geneva	Confirm willingness to engage in Regional Security Dialogue	JIG facilitation
90	Confirm permanent IHTA conversion; UN neutral chair appointment confirmed	Confirm permanent IHTA conversion; first chair rotation	UN Secretary-General + JIG unanimous certification
120	Process fourth asset tranche (20%; cumulative 70%); Stage 3 sanctions tranche (petrochemicals, oil services, Tier 2 banking)	Confirm nuclear moratorium maintenance; IAEA annual review clean	JIG verification; Congressional review window

150	US Department of Energy confirms Section 123 Agreement negotiation framework opened	Iran formally requests Section 123 negotiation; confirms fuel supply guarantee discussions	Joint announcement; IAEA fuel bank access confirmed
180	Process fifth asset tranche (15%; cumulative 85%); confirm successor framework opening	Confirm Stage 3 closing compliance; confirm successor framework opening	JIG closing certification; 180-day comprehensive compliance review published

Appendix B: Diplomatic Framing Guide

Every provision in this Accord can be characterized in multiple ways. The table below provides diplomatically accurate framing for both sides on every major element.

Table 21 *Dual Framing Reference*

ELEMENT	US FRAMING	IRANIAN FRAMING
Stockpile transfer to Oman	"Weapons-grade material removed from Iranian territory"	"Sovereign asset held in trust under international supervision; Iran chose Oman"
12-year moratorium	"12-year moratorium with automatic extension on violation"	"Time-limited sovereign commitment; NPT rights fully preserved"
Fordow conversion	"Most sensitive facility permanently neutralized"	"Iranian scientists lead world-class medical research center"
IHTA governance	"International authority prevents unilateral Iranian closure"	"Permanent Iranian co-equality replacing US unilateralism"
Tolling revenue	"Revenue channeled to civilian reconstruction, not IRGC"	"Direct revenue stream from Hormuz co-governance funds national reconstruction"
Asset return tranches	"Tranche architecture with Congressional oversight"	"Irreversible return of sovereign property"

SWIFT reconnection	"Conditional compliance"	on FATF	"Banking normalization restoring sovereign fiscal capacity"
Synchronized lift	"Iran lifts Hormuz restrictions simultaneously with US blockade lift"		"US lifts blockade simultaneously with Hormuz reopening -- neither moves alone"
Verification	"Five-channel verification prevents Iranian cheating"		"Multi-source verification ensures no single power controls compliance findings"
Sovereign Energy Partnership	"Iran accepted civilian-only nuclear program"		"Iran proposed the Sovereign Energy Partnership as a sovereign choice"

Appendix C: Glossary of Key Terms

TERM	DEFINITION
Accord	This document; the Stability First Accord v1.0
BAP	Binding Arbitration Panel -- dispute resolution body
CCP	Commercial Continuity Protocol -- protects private-sector contracts
DFC	US International Development Finance Corporation
Dual Blockade	Iranian Hormuz restrictions plus US naval blockade on Iranian ports, operating simultaneously
ESPA	Emergency Snapback Prevention Authority
HEU	Highly Enriched Uranium (60% U-235 in Iran's stockpile)
IHTA	International Hormuz Transit Authority -- permanent governance body
IMIRC	International Medical Isotope Research Center -- converted Fordow facility
JHA	Joint Hormuz Authority -- provisional Stage 1-2 governance body
JIG	Joint Implementation Group -- central coordination body (Geneva)
JMOC	Joint Monitoring Operations Center

LEU	Low Enriched Uranium (3.67% U-235 -- civilian fuel grade)
MCC	Maritime Coordination Cell -- operational nerve center in Muscat/Khasab
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding -- one-page war-termination framework under review May 2026
NPT	Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons
OFAC	Office of Foreign Assets Control (US Treasury)
Project Freedom	US Navy Hormuz escort operation (launched May 4, paused May 6, 2026)
RCSA	Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture v3.6 -- successor framework
Section 123 Agreement	US Atomic Energy Act agreement for civilian nuclear cooperation
Sovereign Energy Partnership	Framing of the nuclear exchange as Iran's initiative, not imposed dismantlement
Sovereignty Milestone	Branded compliance step representing progress toward greater sovereignty
SWIFT	Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication
Waltz Philosophy	Synchronized reciprocal motion principle -- neither side moves alone

Document Certification

This Stability First Accord v1.0 was compiled on May 9, 2026, from five source documents and calibrated to the diplomatic situation as of May 7, 2026. It is a reference instrument for negotiators, not a treaty text. All provisions are drawn from previously published diplomatic frameworks and tailored to current negotiation parameters.

Status: Diplomatic Working Document | For Official Use Only

Version: 1.0 | May 2026

Source Frameworks: Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0 | RCSA Simplified Edition 2026 | RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition | Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0 | Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0

Mediation Channels: Pakistan (primary) | Oman (technical) | Switzerland (financial) | IAEA (nuclear)

Successor Pathway: RCSA v3.6 / Crescent Compact v1.7 / RAMES v9.1